Appendix

FAREWELL SPEECH

All my friends … settle down, let me talk, I will get more and more emotional … my life, between 22 yards for twenty-four years, it's hard to believe that that wonderful journey is coming to an end, but I would like to take this opportunity to thank people who've played an important role in my life. Also, for the first time in my life I am carrying this list, to remember all the names in case I forget someone. I hope you understand … it's getting a little difficult to talk, but I'll manage.

The most, the most important person in my life, and I have missed him a lot since 1999 when he passed away, my father. Without … without his guidance, I don't think I would have been standing here in front of you. He gave me freedom at the age of eleven and told me 'Chase your dreams, but make sure you don't find short cuts. The path might be difficult, but don't give up.' And I have simply followed his instructions. Above all, he told me to be a nice human being, which I will continue to do so, I have tried my best. Every time, every time I have done something special, whenever I've showed my bat, it was for my father, so I miss him today.

My mother, I don't know how she dealt with such a naughty child like me. I was not easy to manage. She must be extremely patient. For a mother, the most important thing is that her child remains safe and healthy and fit, and that's what she was most bothered about and worried about. She, she took care of me … for the last twenty-four years that I have played for India, but even before that, she started praying for me the day I started playing cricket. She just prayed and prayed and prayed,